

Secure-by-Design Azure Governance

Embedding security and governance controls into enterprise Azure provisioning workflows.

385

Azure subscriptions

Minutes

Automated provisioning

Policy

Preventive guardrails

PIM

Privileged access
integration

CONTEXT

In a large Azure estate, applying security controls only after deployment created repeated remediation work and inconsistent configurations. The objective was to move key security and governance requirements into the provisioning process so new subscriptions and resources were created with appropriate controls applied by default.

SCOPE

Technical design and implementation of security and governance controls integrated into enterprise Azure provisioning workflows, including Azure Policy / Policy-as-Code, Defender for Cloud, RBAC/PIM integration, ServiceNow and Azure DevOps. The focus was security and governance enforcement within platform workflows rather than general Azure platform ownership.

KEY WORK

- Embedded security and governance controls into automated Azure provisioning workflows.
- Implemented Azure Policy and Policy-as-Code guardrails, including preventive DENY controls where appropriate.
- Integrated Defender for Cloud security requirements into provisioning.
- Incorporated RBAC and PIM governance into subscription and resource onboarding.
- Connected ServiceNow request workflows with Azure DevOps implementation pipelines.
- Automated repeatable security and governance steps that had previously required manual coordination.

OUTCOMES

- **Provisioning:** reduced processes that previously took days of manual coordination to automated execution in minutes after approval.
- **Consistency:** applied security and governance controls systematically at provisioning time.
- **Drift reduction:** reduced repetitive post-deployment remediation by shifting controls left.
- **Governance:** improved consistency of Azure Policy, Defender and privileged-access controls for newly provisioned environments.
- **Scale:** established reusable guardrails designed for a 385-subscription enterprise Azure estate.

TECHNOLOGY

Azure Policy

Policy-as-Code
Microsoft Defender for Cloud
Azure RBAC
PIM
ServiceNow
Azure DevOps
PowerShell
Bicep / Infrastructure as Code